

SOP STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE		 supplement factory		SOP Number	5.47
				Version number	06
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Food Defence					
Issue date	03/JUN/25	Effective date	03/JUN/25	Review by	03/JUN/27

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1.0 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure is to describe the ‘Food Defence’ approach taken at Supplement Factory.

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2.0 SCOPE

Departments, Job Functions	This SOP applies to all Supplement Factory employees in the Ashford Manufacturing Site and Warehouse. -AND- This SOP applies to Supplement Factory employees, contractors, and consultants in the following departments: All Departments -AND- This SOP applies to the following job functions: All Staff
Limitations	This SOP does not apply to any operations carried out before the effective date of this procedure.

3.0 DELEGATION OF ACTIVITIES

Delegation	Responsible parties in the procedure may delegate an activity but retain responsibility for the outcome. Delegation can only be made to personnel who have been appropriately trained.
	Activities delegated to external contractors must be documented in a contract.

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4.0 PROCEDURE

	Responsibility	Instruction
4.1	All Staff	The GFSI definition of Food Defence is: “The process to ensure the security of food and drink from all forms of intentional malicious attack including ideologically motivated attack leading to contamination”
4.2	All Staff	There are several routes from which deliberate contamination would be possible. This procedure explains how Supplement Factory minimises the risk of such contamination.
4.3	All Staff	Site Security Unauthorised access to facilities is a significant risk. Site security is subject to a risk assessment which is reviewed annually and following any significant business change or incident. Supplement Factory warehouse, factory and offices are all equipped with access control systems which only allow authorised access to various areas. All sites also have security alarms which are monitored remotely by the security contractor. The factory and office sites have external & internal CCTV systems fitted.
4.4	All Staff	Visitors/Contractors There is a possibility that visitors to site may have access to areas of the facility where it may be possible to contaminate product either deliberately or through ignorance of procedure. All visitors to the office or factory and warehouse sites are logged and must complete a visitors form on SwipedOn according to SOP 1.02 Visitor Policy. The policy requires that all visitors to site are accompanied at all times by Supplement Factory staff and that they are forbidden to interact with product or equipment unless specifically authorised. Visitors are also not allowed to enter warehouse or factory areas with undeclared materials or tools. All Supplement Factory staff are asked to challenge or report to line management anyone unaccompanied within the factory or warehouse that they do not recognise.

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4.5	All Staff	Employees There is a possibility that employees may deliberately contaminate product. Access to production and warehouse areas is restricted to authorised trained employees only unless accompanied by authorised member of staff. All operational staff are fully trained and supervised until such time that they are authorised to work alone. CCTV monitors internal warehouse and factory areas SOP 1.01 Personal Hygiene restricts materials that may be taken into production areas. All staff are asked to challenge or report to management any member of staff they observe acting in a suspicious manner. If necessary suspicion can be reported to management in a confidential manner.
4.6	All Staff	Raw material and components It is possible that product could be contaminated through the use of contaminated raw materials or components. All deliveries are inspected at goods in according to SOP 4.01 to ensure there are no signs or damage or tampering with deliveries. In addition at point of use in Production any open or damaged containers would not be used. Full truck inspection records of delivery vehicles are kept. Goods are only purchased from approved, accredited suppliers according to SOP 5.16. Materials are only stored in authorised warehouse areas under Supplement Factory control. Risk assessment are also carried out on the risk of receiving contaminated or fraudulent materials according to SOP 4.16.
4.7	All Staff	Product All product is packed using tamper evident packaging where possible.
4.8	All Staff	Any possible or actual incident involving Food Defence must be documented on a Quality Incident form and subject to formal corrective and preventive action according to SOP 5.03

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4.9	HACCP Team	The Food Defence policy will be formally reviewed at a minimum annually as part of the HACCP review SOP 5.44.
4.10	Food Defence Training	

5.0 REVISION HISTORY

01	New procedure. Training is required.
02	SOP number error and spelling update
03	Two Year review
04	Update to Supplement Factory Header
05	Update to include Threat Assessment Plan at Appendix 1 following internal audit
06	Updated following internal audit and to reflect changes at BRCGS version 9

6.0 REFERENCES

6.1.	BRCGS 4.2
6.2.	Associated Documents
	SOP 4.01 Receipt Identification and Storage of Materials SOP 4.02 Truck Inspection SOP 4.16 Raw Material Risk Assessment & Authenticity Vulnerability Assessment SOP 5.03 Quality Incidents SOP 5.16 Approval of GMP Suppliers and Service Providers SOP 5.44 HACCP Review Security Risk Assessment

7.0 DISTRIBUTION LIST

All Staff

8.0 APPENDICES

8.1	Appendix 1: Threat Assessment Plan
8.2	Appendix 2: Competency Test

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8.1 Appendix 1: THREAT ASSESSMENT PLAN

BRCGS 4.2.2 requires that a Threat Assessment Plan be drawn up as a result of the Food Defence Risk assessment being conducted or in this case updated. The Food Defence Risk Assessment was updated to reflect the positioning of Freezers in the Javelin car park and changes in Customer base which mean higher value stock is stored at the Axiom warehouse.

Identified Threats to Food Defence

1. Unauthorised staff access to warehouse or production areas.
There is a risk of inadvertent stock mix-ups or contamination by untrained staff.
2. Unauthorised visitor access during working hours.
There is a risk of contamination of product by visitors.
3. Break-in during closed hours.
There is a risk of unauthorised access to controlled areas at night or weekends. This may lead to contamination or damage to equipment.
4. Deliberate product contamination.
There is a risk of deliberate contamination by employees or visitors.
5. Cross contamination via staff or visitors.
There is a risk that product is contaminated by inadvertent cross contamination by staff or visitors.
6. Freezer Container storage in carpark for Frozen Pizza products. Also used for palletised Probiotic raw materials.
There is a risk of unauthorised access to the freezers at night or weekend. This may lead to contamination or spoilage of product or damage to the equipment.
7. Raw Materials or Products that are at particular risk.
Raw materials or Products of high value might increase the risk of break in and theft. Raw materials that require storage at particular temperatures (Fridge or Freezer) may be at risk in the event of a power failure.

Mitigation to Threats

The mitigation to the threats identified is two-fold:

- 1, Vigilance – all staff need to remain vigilant to the treats identified and report anything suspicious to senior management.
2. Implementation of Policies and Procedures – all staff need to ensure that the appropriate policies and procedures are being implemented and any associated equipment failures i.e. CC TV systems are reported and fixed where necessary.

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8.2 APPENDIX 2: COMPETENCY TEST

Full training of this SOP requires successful completion of the following competency test:

1. Question 1: The object of a Food Defence plan is to:

- | | | |
|--|---------------------------------|--|
| a. Minimise risk of deliberate product contamination | b. To ensure quality of product | c. To gather evidence on poorly performing employees |
|--|---------------------------------|--|

2. Question 2: Possible routes of deliberate contamination to product include? Tick all that apply

- | | | |
|-------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|
| a. Visitors | b. Use of cheap materials | c. Break in to premises |
|-------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|

3. Question 3: Any possible incident involving Food Defence is reported on

- | | | |
|------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|
| a. Police report | b. Personnel record | c. Quality Incident Report |
|------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|

PASS MARK = 100%

It will not always be necessary for this assessment to occur if the individual has successfully been performing this task within Supplement Factory and according to the standards required in this SOP for more than 6 months. This should be justified and noted in the training record.

Name of Trainee:		
Competency test (delete as appropriate):	Pass	Fail
On the job assessment (if applicable)(delete as appropriate):	Pass	Fail
Signed by Trainee:	Date:	
Signed by Trainer:	Date:	

The signatures above denote successful completion of training. This must be recorded in the individual's training record by the trainer.

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